Engineering Onboarding Guide

NimbusDesk Internal Engineering Handbook

Week One Setup

New engineers are provisioned a laptop, a company email, and access to the internal wiki on their first day. Access to production systems is granted only after completing the required security training module, which takes approximately 2 hours and must be finished within the first 5 business days. Engineers are assigned a buddy from their team who is responsible for answering day-to-day questions for the first 30 days.

Development Environment

All engineers use the internal CLI tool called nimctl to spin up local development environments. Running nimctl init creates a fully configured local stack, including a local database seeded with anonymized sample data. The onboarding checklist requires new engineers to successfully run the full test suite locally before their first pull request is reviewed.

Code Review Standards

Every pull request requires at least 2 approvals before merging, with at least one approval from a senior engineer on the team. Pull requests that touch billing or authentication code require an additional review from a member of the Security team, regardless of the size of the change. Reviews are expected to be completed within 1 business day of being requested.

Deployment Process

NimbusDesk deploys to production multiple times per day using an automated CI/CD pipeline. Any engineer can trigger a deployment once their pull request is merged to the main branch, but deployments outside of core business hours (9am-6pm local time) require sign-off from the on-call engineer. Rollbacks can be triggered by any engineer at any time without requiring approval, since reverting a bad change is always considered lower risk than leaving it live.

Performance Reviews

Formal performance reviews happen twice a year, in June and December. New engineers receive their first informal check-in at the 90-day mark, which does not affect compensation but is used to confirm the new hire is ramping up successfully. Engineers promoted mid-cycle have their next formal review moved to align with the standard June or December schedule, rather than being reviewed early.

Internal Tooling Directory

The most commonly used internal tools are: nimctl (local development), Argus (internal monitoring dashboard), Beacon (feature flag management), and Ledger (internal billing reconciliation tool). Access to Ledger is restricted to the Finance Engineering team and requires a separate access request even for engineers who already have general production access.